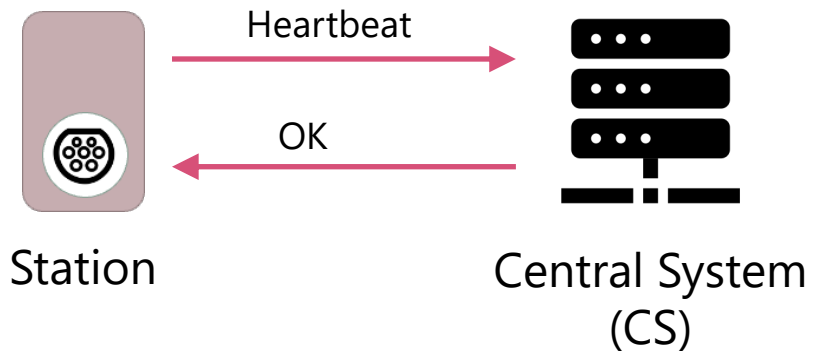


3. HEARTBEATS



Heartbeats Tell that a Station is Alive



Heartbeats are messages that a station sends to the central system to indicate that it is still **functioning properly**. They allow the central system to know that the station is alive and can be used to monitor the status of the station.

Heartbeats are typically sent **at regular intervals**, as specified by the central system in the response to a boot notification request.



Heartbeat.req and .conf messages

Example request:

```
[2, "533-ab-22911", "Heartbeat",  
{}]
```

Example response:

```
[3, "533-ab-22911",  
{ "currentTime": "2025-02-25T18:12:55Z" }]
```

The heartbeat request message is really simple: it does not have any contents. It is just an empty message that is used by the station to tell the central system that the station is still online.

The heartbeat response message has a bit more data: the central system responds back to the station with the **current time** of the central system. This information is used to ensure that the station is following the same time as the central system.

